

Reflection Report Semester 2 , Year 2

Introduction and Connection to Former Reflection Papers

Looking back at the second semester of my second year, I can say it was one of the most challenging times of my life, both academically and personally. In my past reflection report, I wrote about a main rule I have for myself: regardless of the situation, I finish the job successfully. I have always been proud of my hard work, but this semester really was the ultimate test.

The war going on right now has deeply hurt my mental health. Seeing all the bad news caused a lot of anxiety, sadness, and made me feel very tired emotionally. Many days, it was hard to focus on coding or schoolwork because of everything happening back home. Just opening my laptop felt like a huge task. But, I stuck to my routine. I used my schoolwork, team meetings, and my part time job to keep me busy and grounded. I am very proud to say that even with the heavy mental stress, I kept going and finished all of my courses successfully. I proved to myself that my ability to keep going is real, just like I wrote in my past reflection reports.

Personal Development Plan and Goals

These goals were about learning new IT skills and growing my professional network. I am happy to say that I achieved all of my PDP goals this semester.

My first goal was to learn the basics of the Vue.js framework . I wanted to improve my front-end development skills outside of regular classes to help me get a good internship . To do this, I finished a 7-hour YouTube course, studying and coding for 3 hours a week . I used what I learned to build a working web app and uploaded it to my [GitHub](#) . This extra learning really helped when working with my project group on our web app.

My second goal was to learn more skills by taking a beginner AI development course . Since I think automation is going to be very important, I wanted to learn the basics of this fast-growing part of tech . I took an online course and spent 2 hours every weekend watching the lessons and doing the coding exercises . Learning these new skills makes me feel more ready for the future of IT.

My third goal was about being more professional . I realized that not being seen by IT recruiters was a problem . I wanted to be more active on my LinkedIn profile and grow my network . I promised to update my profile within 48 hours of finishing any new project . I also sent message requests to IT professionals . Because of this, I grew my network from 60 to my goal of 100 connections and now is over that number.

Receiving and Giving Feedback

A big part of my growth this semester was improving how I talk and work with my new team. In my previous reflection report, I wrote that I needed to work on how I correct others in a nice way.

Although that I was not a scrum master which is equivalent to team leader

I decided to use the BECD (Behaviour, Effect, Consequence, Direction) method to give

feedback clearly and avoid misunderstandings . Working closely with my project team meant we needed to talk openly.

It was also important for me to accept feedback. I asked my teammates to give me feedback so I knew how they felt about my work . This clear way of talking helped me not get defensive. It helped me see what I need to fix like my weakness in planning and change myself if needed to help the team . Using this feedback method kept our group happy and helped us finish our projects successfully.